bagoong carbonara

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Italian classic with a Filipino twist. Bagoong is a Filipino fermented condiment usually made with shrimp or fish. It has a strong smell, some may be turned off by it but it tastes amazing. It's salty, loaded with umami and adds a nice funk. Here, I tossed it into the very simple and luscious carbonara. Eggs, pork, and bagoong. Add in some pecorino cheese. Lots of umami, you'll love it! A wonderful combo.

You don't need to make fresh pasta for this recipe. Dried is just as good, maybe even better. Also if you can't find guanciale, sub with pancetta or bacon. The smokiness from the bacon with the bagoong would be so good.

Recipe

Serves 2

Ingredients:

Pasta Dough: makes about 1/2 pound

- 90 grams 00 durum flour
- 90 grams semolina flour
- 5 egg yolks
- 1 egg

Method:

1. Place your flours on a clean surface and form a well.
2. Place your egg yolks and eggs into the well. Carefully whisk eggs and incorporate flour into the egg while keeping the flour wall intact.

3. Once egg/flour mixture is thick, incorporate all flour with eggs and knead into a dough.
4. Keep kneading until dough is cohesive. It will feel dry at first but keep going. If it's still dry after about 5 mins of kneading add a splash of water.
5. Cover with plastic wrap and let dough rest at room temperature for at least 1 hour.
6. Cut dough in half. With a rolling pin, roll dough thin enough to fit pasta machine. Working your way down from the largest setting. Roll to level 4 and fold in thirds. Roll thin enough to fit pasta roller's largest setting. Put through pasta machine until desired thickness (I went to level 6). Repeat with other half of dough.
7. You can hand cut pasta if you'd like. Use a pasta cutter attachment or use a chitarra . Be sure to flour pasta after shaping to avoid it sticking together.
8. To cook pasta, in a pot of boiling salted water. Cook pasta for about 3 minutes until al dente.

Bagoong Carbonara:

Ingredients:

- 8 oz pasta, fresh or dried
- 2 oz guanciale, cut into lardons
- 1 large egg + 2 yolks
- 1.5 oz grated pecorino cheese
- 1 tsp bagoong
- Generous amount of black pepper
- Kosher salt, to taste

Method:

1. Bring a pot of water to boil. Add enough salt to make it taste like the sea.
2. As you wait for the water to boil, over medium low heat, render guanciale in a

bit of olive oil until crispy. About 5 minutes. Using a slotted spoon, remove crispy guanciale and set aside. Reserve guanciale fat and pan.

3. In a bowl, whisk together eggs, and a generous amount of black pepper. Fold in pecorino cheese. Set aside.
4. Once guanciale pan has cooled down slightly, add bagoong to toast slightly.
5. Add pasta to boiling water.
6. Add about 1/2 cup of pasta water to reserved pan with guanciale fat/bagoong. Bring to simmer. Reserve some more pasta water separately (about 1 cup should be good).
7. Cook pasta a little less than al dente. Once pasta is cooked, drain and transfer pasta into reserved pan with guanciale fat/bagoong.
8. On medium low heat, continuously mix pasta and stream in egg mixture. Toss until it has thickened and coats the pasta. Should have a cream like consistency. You don't want to cook your eggs here. Add splashes of pasta water if too thick.
9. Fold in crispy guanciale. Season with salt if necessary.
10. Top with more cheese. Enjoy!

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